

ROUTINE CORRESPONDENCE

negative

ooo

positive



Persuasive

Week 5

AGENDA

1



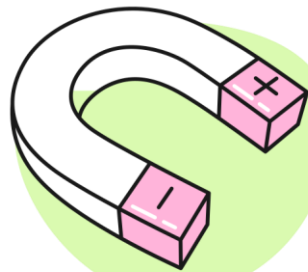
Effective strategy for writing routine business requests.

2



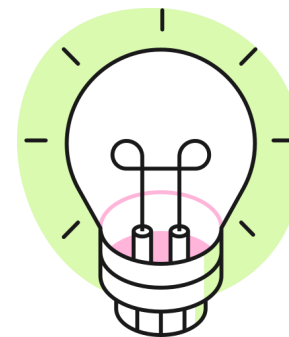
Three common types of routine requests.

3

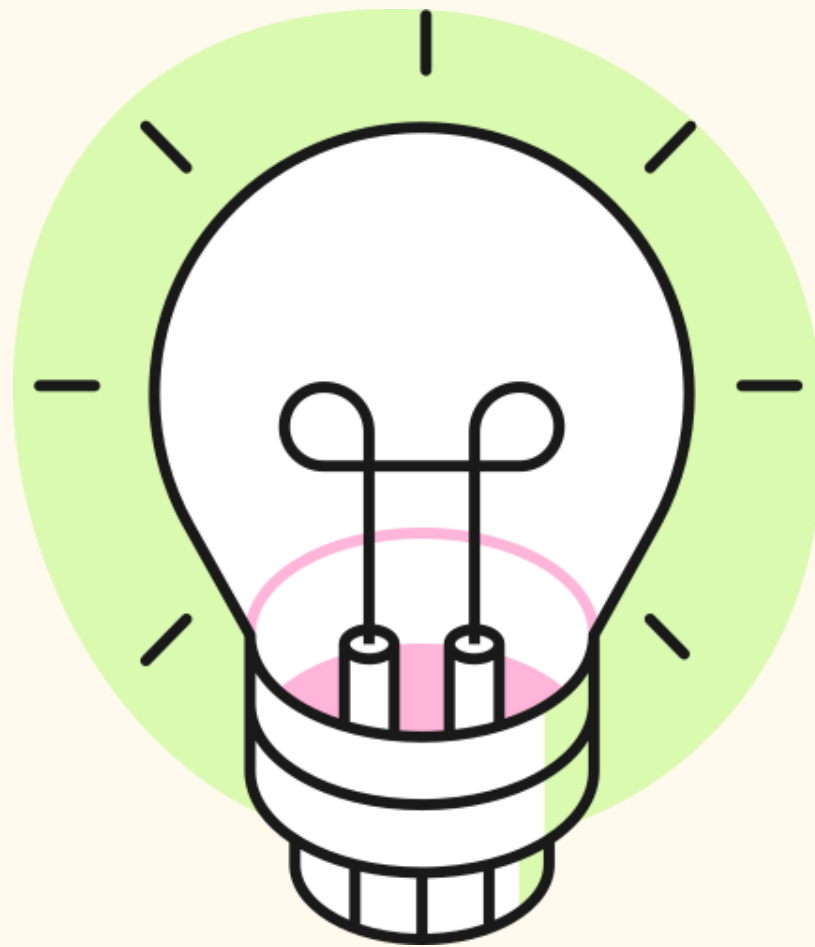


Effective strategy for writing routine replies and positive messages.

4



Describe six common types of routine replies and positive messages.



ROUTINE MESSAGES

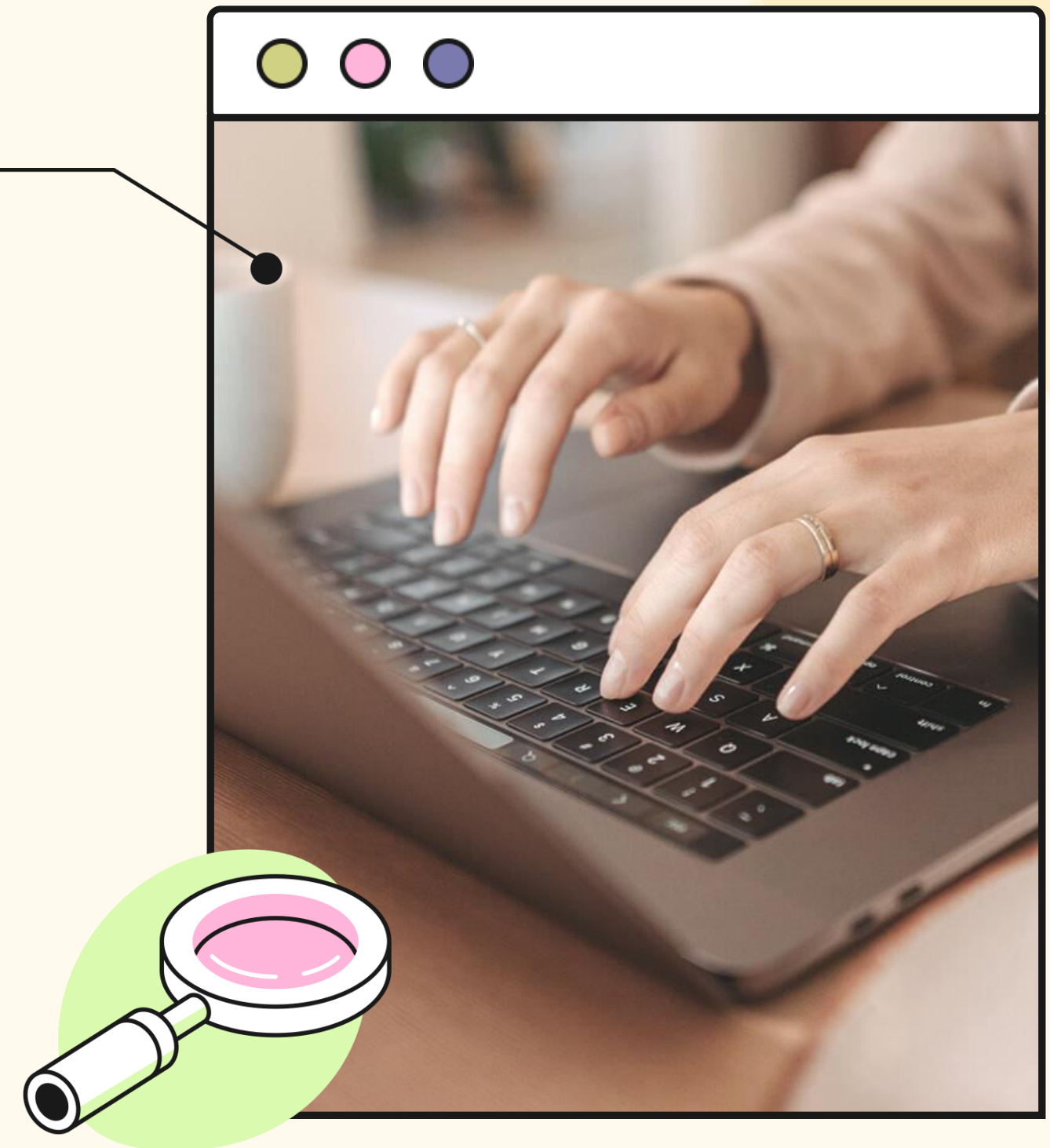
A routine request, such as a request for information, is one of the most common kinds of writing.

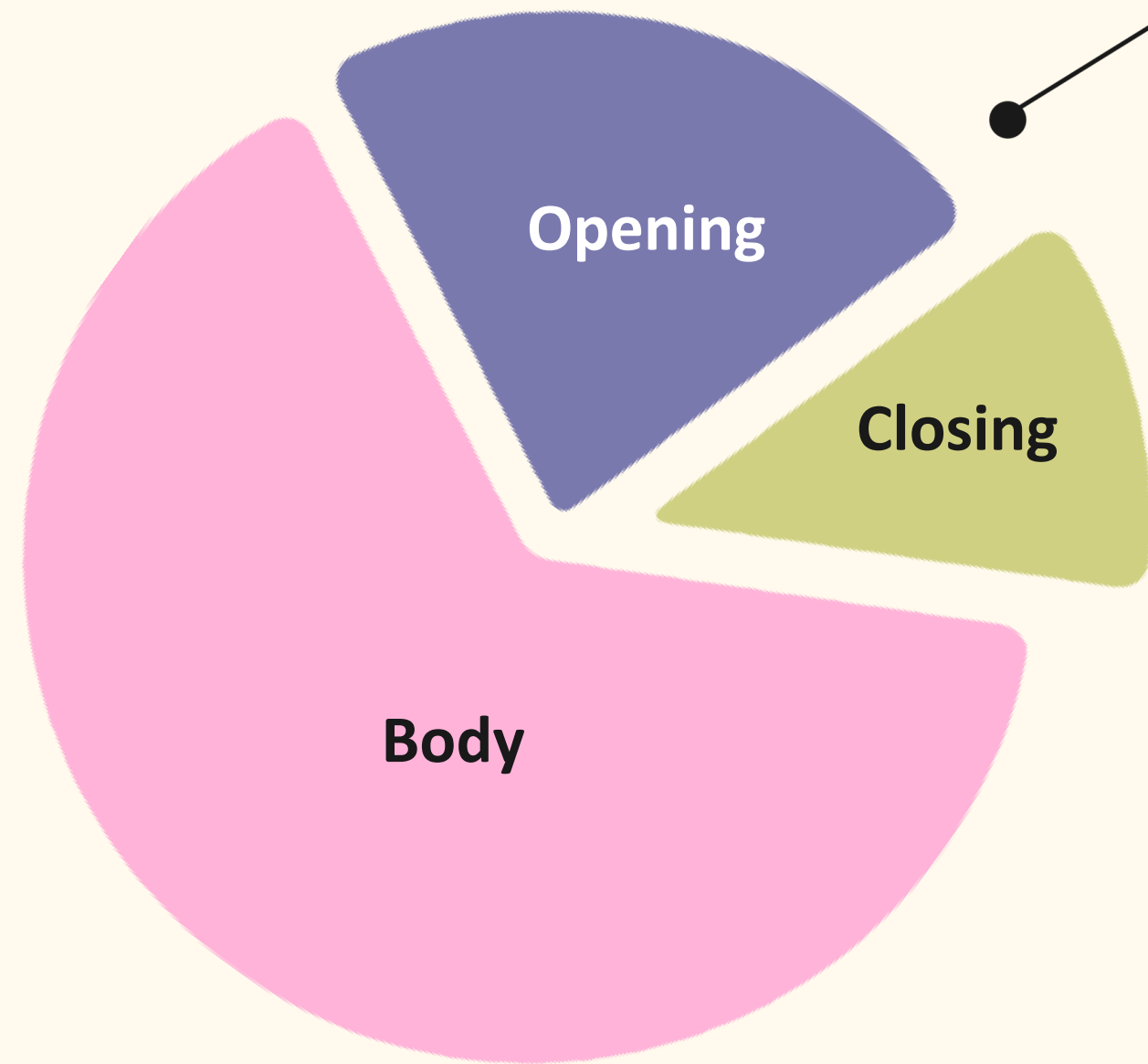
A request is routine when (1) you are not asking a special favor, and (2) you expect your request to be accepted.

In a routine request, it is not necessary to try to persuade your reader because saying “yes” to your request is a routine part of your reader’s job.

Making requests is a routine part of business, and in most cases your audience will be prepared to comply.

By applying a clear strategy and tailoring your approach to each situation, you'll be able to generate effective requests quickly.





ROUTINE REQUEST

For routine requests and positive messages

- State the request or main idea
- Give necessary details and justify your request
- Close with a cordial request for specific action



1

- STATING YOUR REQUEST UP FRONT
- EXPLAINING AND JUSTIFYING YOUR REQUEST
- REQUESTING SPECIFIC ACTION IN A COURTEOUS CLOSE

Effective strategy for writing routine business requests.



OPENING: STATING YOUR REQUEST UP FRONT

PAY ATTENTION TO TONE.

Instead of demanding action (“Send me the latest version of the budget spreadsheet”), show respect by using words such as please and I would appreciate.

ASSUME THAT YOUR AUDIENCE WILL COMPLY.

You can generally assume that your readers will comply with routine requests, so you don’t need to devote a lot of time or energy toward trying to convince them to do so.

BE SPECIFIC

State precisely what you want. For example, if you request the latest market data from your research department, be sure to say whether you want a 1-page summary or 100 pages of raw data.

BODY: EXPLAINING AND JUSTIFYING YOUR REQUEST

SMOOTH & LOGICAL

- The explanation of the request should be a smooth out-growth of the opening statements.
- If you have multiple requests or questions, ask the most important questions first and deal with only one topic per question.

READER'S BENEFIT

If complying with the request could benefit the reader, be sure to mention that.

SCAFFOLDING

If you have an unusual or complex request, break it down into specific, individual questions so that the reader can address each one separately.

CLOSING: REQUESTING SPECIFIC ACTION IN A COURTEOUS CLOSE

CALL FOR ACTION

a specific request that
includes
any relevant deadlines,

CONTACT INFORMATION

information about how
you can be reached

SINCERE THANKS

an expression of
appreciation or goodwill.

Send

To...

Cc...

Subject

Jsmith@tbaydelta.com

Conference Facilities June 1 to 3

Subject line clearly states the nature of the inquiry

Dear Ms. Smith:

Can the Delta Hotel provide conference facilities and accommodations for approximately 100 Confederation College employees from June 1 to June 3?

Opens directly with a question

We are particularly interested to learn about the Delta's facilities:

- Do you have a conference room large enough to accommodate all 100 participants at one time?
- Are there smaller rooms available for "break out" sessions in the afternoons?
- Can you provide sufficient wifi for all participants to be using devices simultaneously?
- Are all conference rooms equipped with projectors?
- Can a continental style breakfast be provided to participants on all three days of the conference?
- Will visiting guest speakers be eligible for a reduced room rate?

Uses a bulleted list for multiple questions

Confederation College is celebrating its golden anniversary with a three-day learning and teaching conference for all faculty, and we would love to host this special event at the Delta.

Please provide us information on the Delta's conference facilities, including cost and availability, by February 10.

Reason for request is least important information and is given at the end

Many thanks,
Ash
Ashley Clements
Manager, Marketing and Communications
Confederation College

Closing is polite, reminds reader of the specific request, and provides a deadline

CHECKLIST ✓ Writing Routine Requests

A. State your request up front.

- Write in a polite, undemanding, personal tone.
- Use the direct approach because your audience will probably respond favorably to your request.
- Be specific and precise in your request.

B. Explain and justify your request.

- Justify the request or explain its importance.
- Explain any potential benefits of responding.
- Ask the most important questions first.

- Break complex requests into individual questions that are limited to only one topic each.

C. Request specific action in a courteous close.

- Make it easy to comply by including appropriate contact information.
- Express your gratitude.
- Clearly state any important deadlines for the request.

Activity: Write a routine message, requesting your IT team to update the company website by Monday. The request is to add the bios of three new employees hired in the Marketing department along with their pictures and ambitions before the meeting with your new investors.



2

- Asking for information or action
- Asking for recommendations
- Making claims and requesting adjustments.

**Three common types
of routine requests**



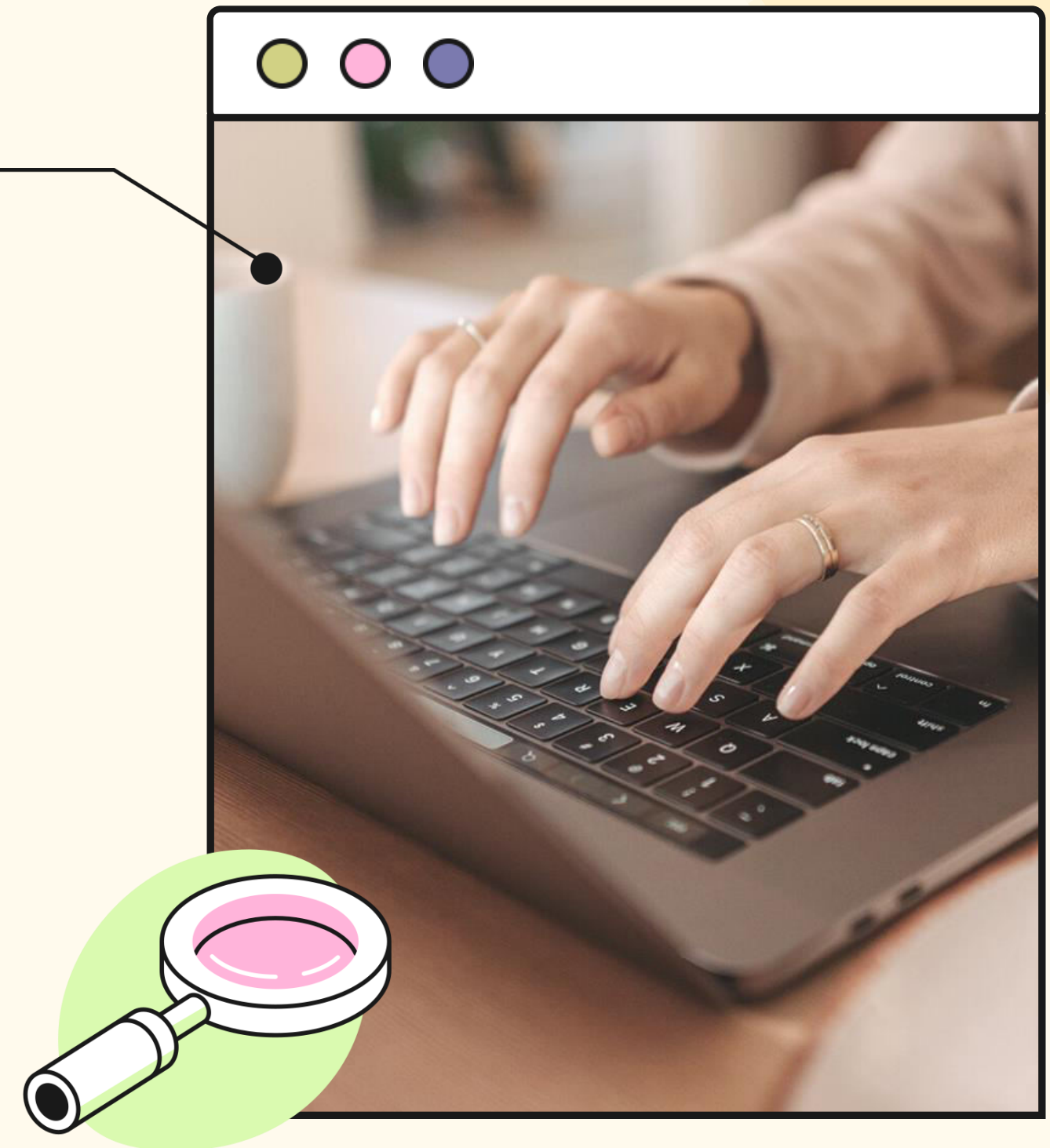


2.1

ASKING FOR INFORMATION

Most simple requests can be handled with three message points:

- What you want to know or what you want your readers to do
- Why you're making the request (not required in all cases)
- Why it may be in your readers' interests to help you (not applicable in all cases)





2.1

ASKING FOR INFORMATION

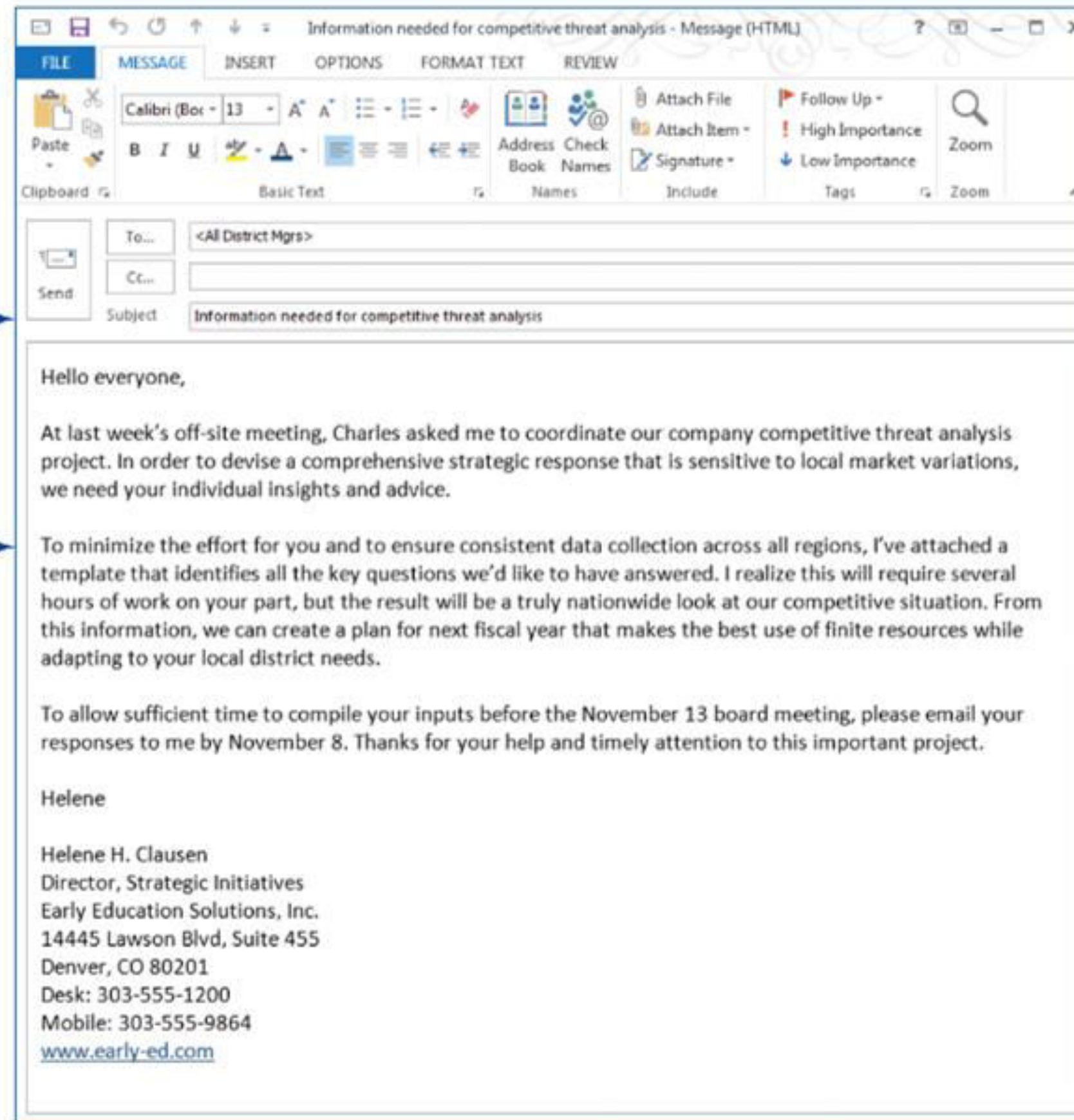
In case of complex requests:

- You may need to provide more extensive reasons and justification for your request.
- If applicable, point out any benefits to the reader of complying with your request.
- Naturally, be sure to adapt your request to your audience and the situation



The informative subject line alerts the audience to an important request.

Clausen acknowledges that responding to the request will require some work but emphasizes that the result will benefit everyone.



The opening explains the context of the message, then gets to the point of the request.

The body explains the benefit of responding to the request.

The close provides a clear deadline, then concludes in a courteous manner.

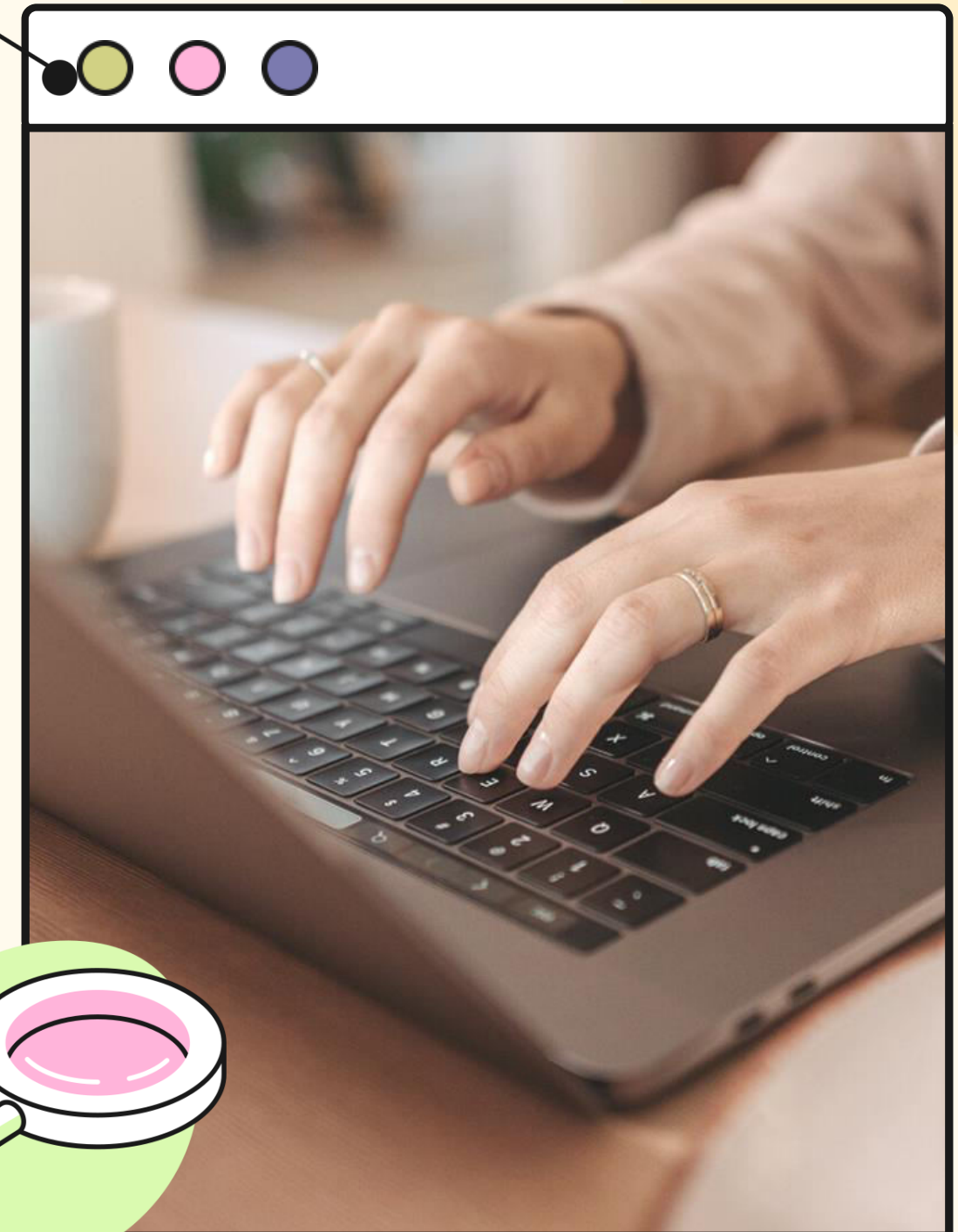
Figure 10.1 Routine Message Requesting Action

In this email request to district managers across the country, Helene Clausen asks them to fill out an attached information collection form. Although the request is not unusual and responding to it is part of the managers' responsibilities, Clausen asks for their help in a courteous manner and points out the benefits of responding.



ASKING FOR RECOMMENDATIONS

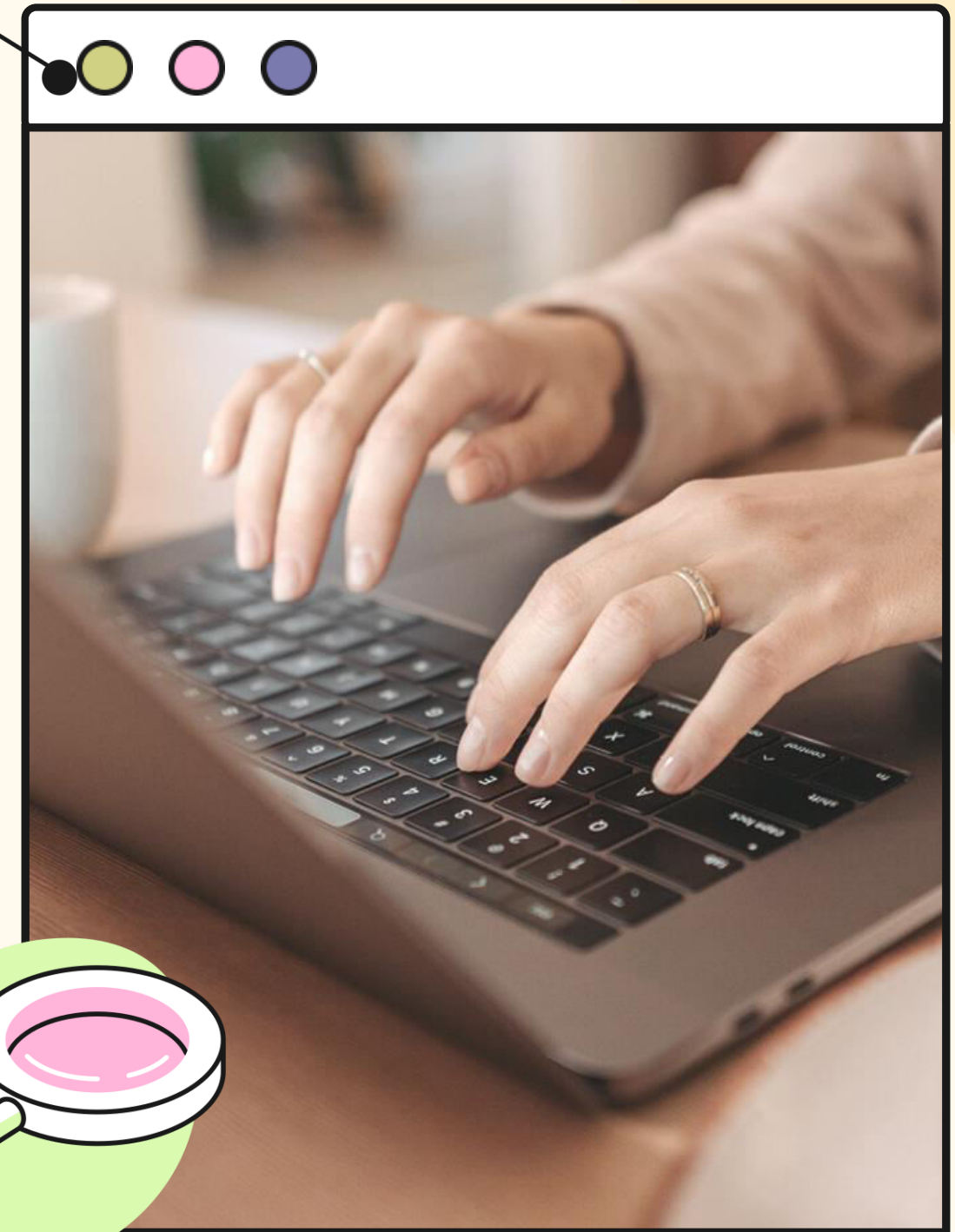
- Companies ask applicants to list people who can vouch for their ability, skills, integrity, character, and fitness for the job.
- Before you volunteer someone's name as a reference, ask permission.
- Requests for recommendations and references are routine, so you can organize your inquiry using the direct approach.





ASKING FOR RECOMMENDATIONS

- Open your message by clearly stating why the recommendation is required (if it's not for a job, be sure to explain its purpose)
- Refresh the memory of any potential reference you haven't been in touch with for a while.
- Close your message with an expression of appreciation and the full name and address (email or physical address) of the person to whom the message should be sent.
- When asking for an immediate recommendation, you should also mention the deadline.



Professor Lyndon Kenton
School of Business
University of Tennessee, Knoxville
Knoxville, TN 37916

Dear Professor Kenton:

I recently interviewed with Strategic Investments and have been called for a second interview for their Analyst Training Program (ATP). They have requested at least one recommendation from a professor, and I immediately thought of you. May I have a letter of recommendation from you?

As you may recall, I took FINC 425, Investment and Portfolio Management, from you during the Fall 2015 semester. I was fascinated by the methods of risk and return analysis you presented, and the class confirmed my decision to pursue a career in investment management.

My enclosed résumé includes all my relevant work experience and volunteer activities. I would also like to add that I've handled the financial planning for our family since my father passed away several years ago. Although I initially learned by trial and error, I have increasingly applied my business training in deciding what stocks or bonds to trade. This, I believe, has given me a practical edge over others who may be applying for the same job.

If possible, Ms. Blackmon in Human Resources needs to receive your letter by March 30. For your convenience, I've enclosed a preaddressed, stamped envelope.

I appreciate your time and effort in writing this letter of recommendation for me. It will be great to put my education to work, and I'll keep you informed of my progress. Thank you for your consideration in this matter.

Sincerely,

Joanne Tucker

Joanne Tucker

Enclosure

→ Tucker includes information near the opening to refresh her professor's memory.

→ She provides a deadline for response and includes information about the person who is expecting the recommendation.

← The opening states the purpose of the letter and makes the request, assuming the reader will want to comply.

← The body refers to the enclosed résumé and mentions experience that could set the applicant apart from other candidates—information the professor could use in writing the recommendation.

← The close is warm and respectful.

Figure 10.2 Effective Request for a Recommendation

This writer uses a direct approach when asking for a recommendation from a former professor. Note how she takes care to refresh the professor's memory because she took the class a year and a half ago. She also indicates the date by which the letter is needed and points to the enclosure of a stamped, preaddressed envelope.

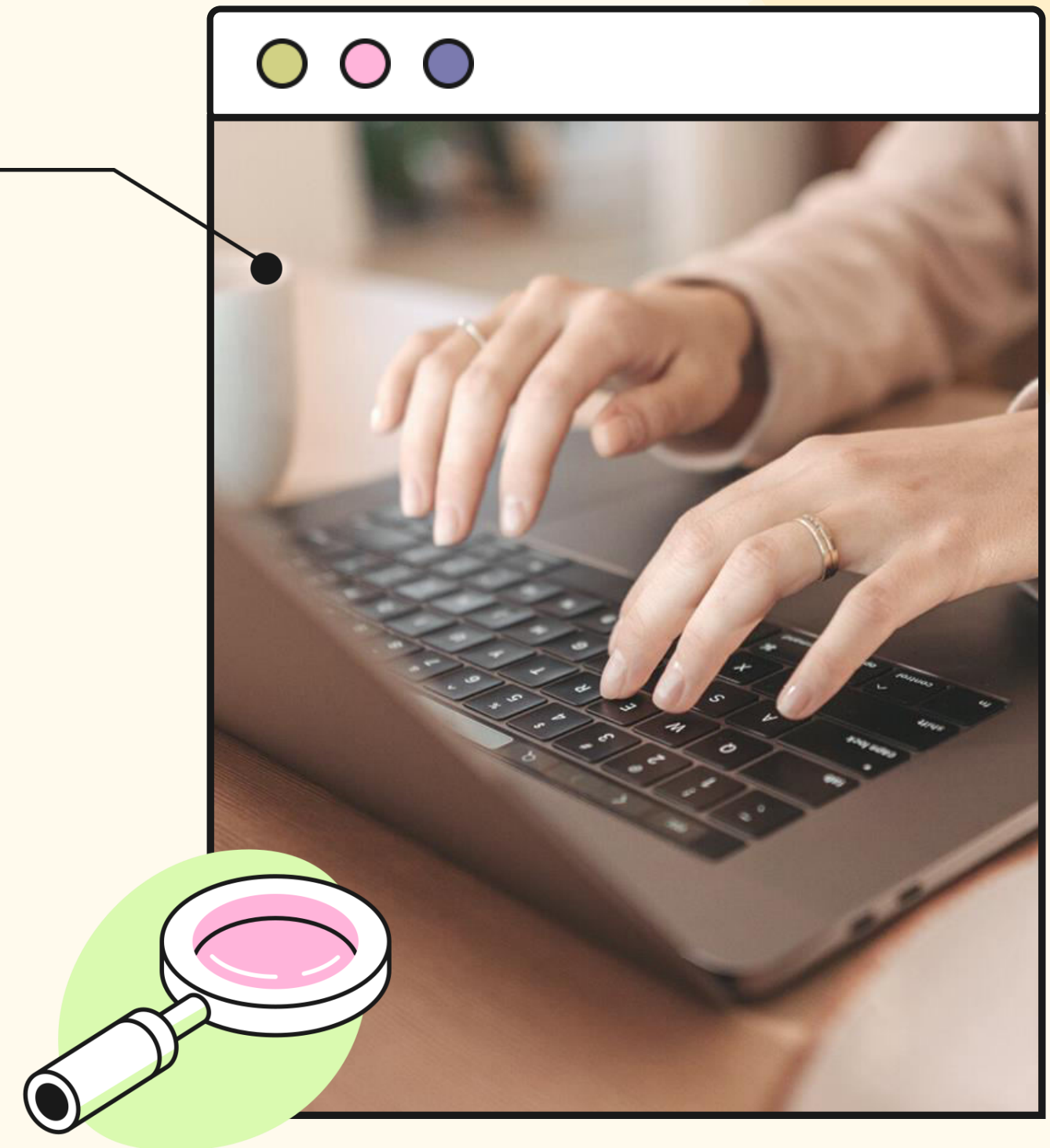


2.3

MAKING CLAIMS & REQUESTING FOR ADJUSTMENTS

When writing a claim or requesting an adjustment:

- Explain the problem and give details
- Provide backup information (any information the recipient needs to verify your complaint.)
- Request specific action (politely request specific action or convey a sincere desire to find a solution.)

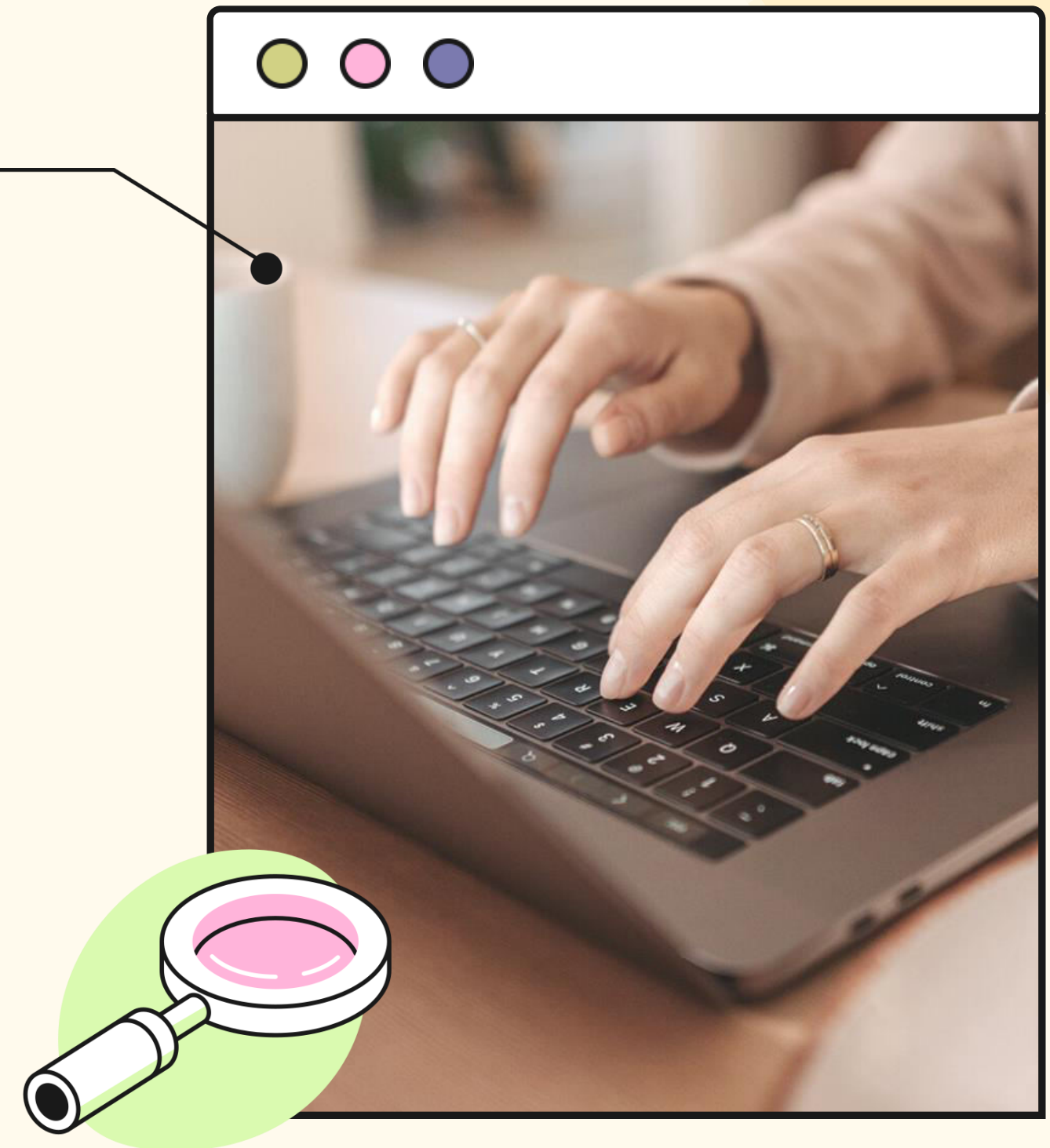




2.3

MAKING CLAIMS & REQUESTING FOR ADJUSTMENTS

if appropriate, suggest that the business relationship will continue if the problem is solved satisfactorily. Be prepared to back up your claim with invoices, sales receipts, canceled checks, dated correspondence, and any other relevant documents. Send copies and keep the originals for your files.



CHECKLIST Making Claims and Requesting Adjustments

- Maintain a professional tone, even if you're extremely frustrated.
- Open with a straightforward statement of the problem.
- Provide specific details in the body.
- Present facts honestly and clearly.
- Politely summarize the desired action in the closing.
- Clearly state what you expect as a fair settlement or ask the reader to propose a fair adjustment.
- Explain the benefits of complying with the request, such as your continued patronage.



3

- STARTING WITH THE MAIN IDEA
- PROVIDING NECESSARY DETAILS AND EXPLANATION
- ENDING WITH A COURTEOUS CLOSE

Effective strategy for writing routine replies and positive messages.





3.1

STARTING WITH THE MAIN IDEA

- Begin with a positive note or a good news, that prepares audience for the next details.
- Make your opening clear and concise.
- State the single most important idea that you have for the audience.



Instead of This

I am pleased to inform you that after careful consideration of a diverse and talented pool of applicants, each of whom did a thorough job of analyzing Trask Horton Pharmaceuticals's training needs, we have selected your bid.

Write This

Trask Horton Pharmaceuticals has accepted your bid to provide public speaking and presentation training to the sales staff.



3.2

PROVIDING NECESSARY DETAILS AND EXPLANATION

- Maintain the positive tone that you begin with.
- The tone is easy to maintain when the message is entirely positive.



Your educational background and internship have impressed us, and we believe you would be a valuable addition to Green Valley Properties. As discussed during your interview, your salary will be \$4,300 per month, plus benefits. Please plan to meet with our benefits manager, Paula Sanchez, at 8 A.M. on Monday, March 21. She will assist you with all the paperwork necessary to tailor our benefit package to your family situation. She will also arrange various orientation activities to help you get on board with the Green Valley team.



PROVIDING NECESSARY DETAILS AND EXPLANATION

- if your routine message is mixed and must convey mildly disappointing information,
- put the negative portion of your message into as favorable a context as possible

Instead of This

No, we no longer carry the HealthTrakk Model V fitness watch.

Write This

The new HealthTrakk Optima has replaced the HealthTrakk Model V. The Optima model features a wider range of band colors and new tracking features, including GPS for outdoor fitness activities.

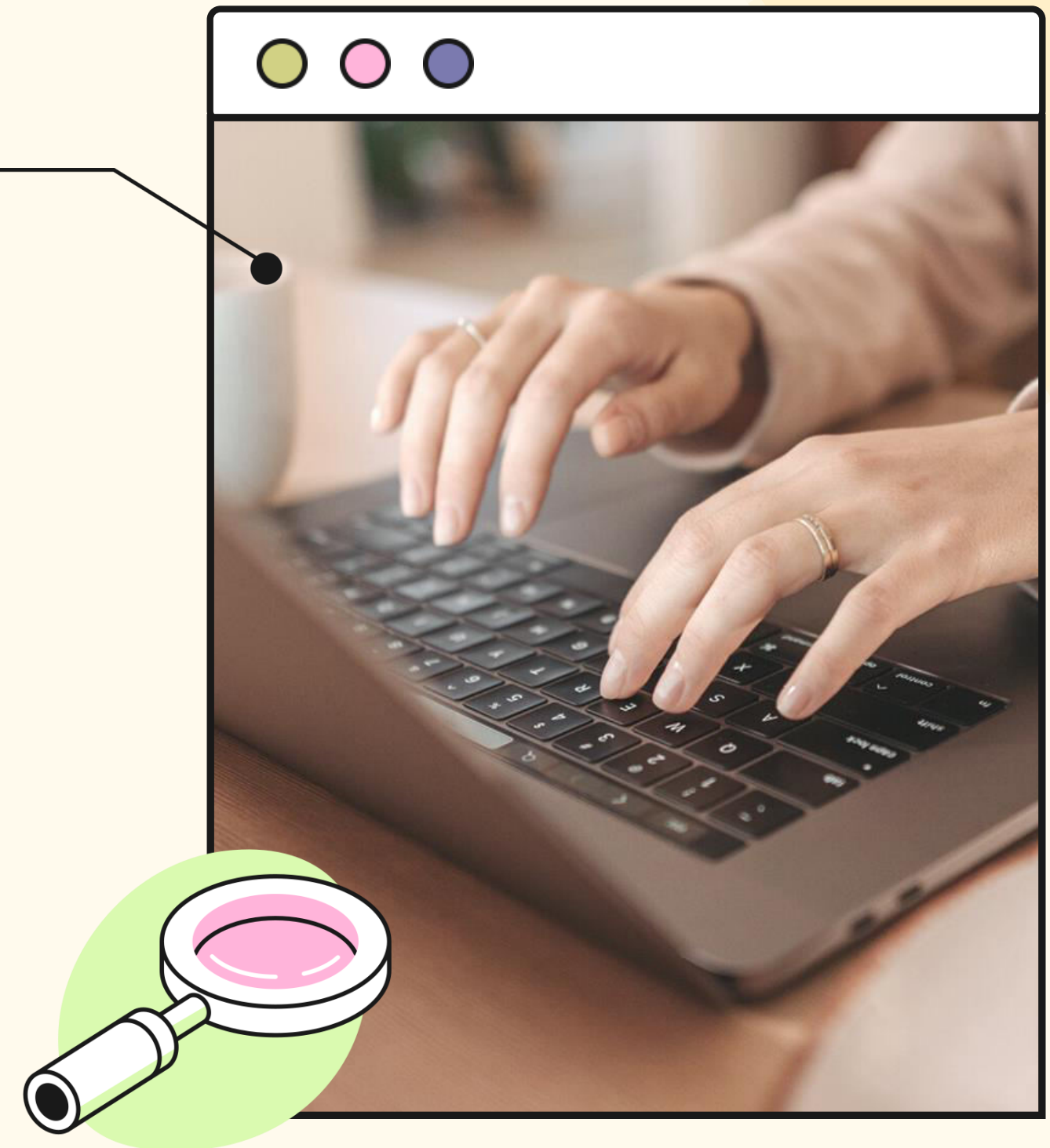




3.3

SENDING WITH A COURTEOUS CLOSE

- Make sure audience members understand what to do next
- How that action will benefit them (if applicable).



CHECKLIST **Writing Routine Replies and Positive Messages**

A. Start with the main idea.

- Be clear and concise.
- Identify the single most important message before you start writing.

B. Provide necessary details and explanation.

- Explain your point completely to eliminate any confusion or lingering doubts.
- Maintain a supportive tone throughout.

- Embed negative statements in positive contexts or balance them with positive alternatives.
- Talk favorably about the choices the customer has made.

C. End with a courteous close.

- Let your readers know you have their personal well-being in mind.
- If further action is required, tell readers how to proceed and encourage them to act promptly.



4

- ANSWERING REQUESTS FOR INFORMATION AND ACTION
- GRANTING CLAIMS AND REQUESTS FOR ADJUSTMENT
- PROVIDING RECOMMENDATIONS AND REFERENCES
- SHARING ROUTINE INFORMATION
- ANNOUNCING GOOD NEWS
- FOSTERING GOODWILL

**Six common types
of routine replies and positive
messages.**



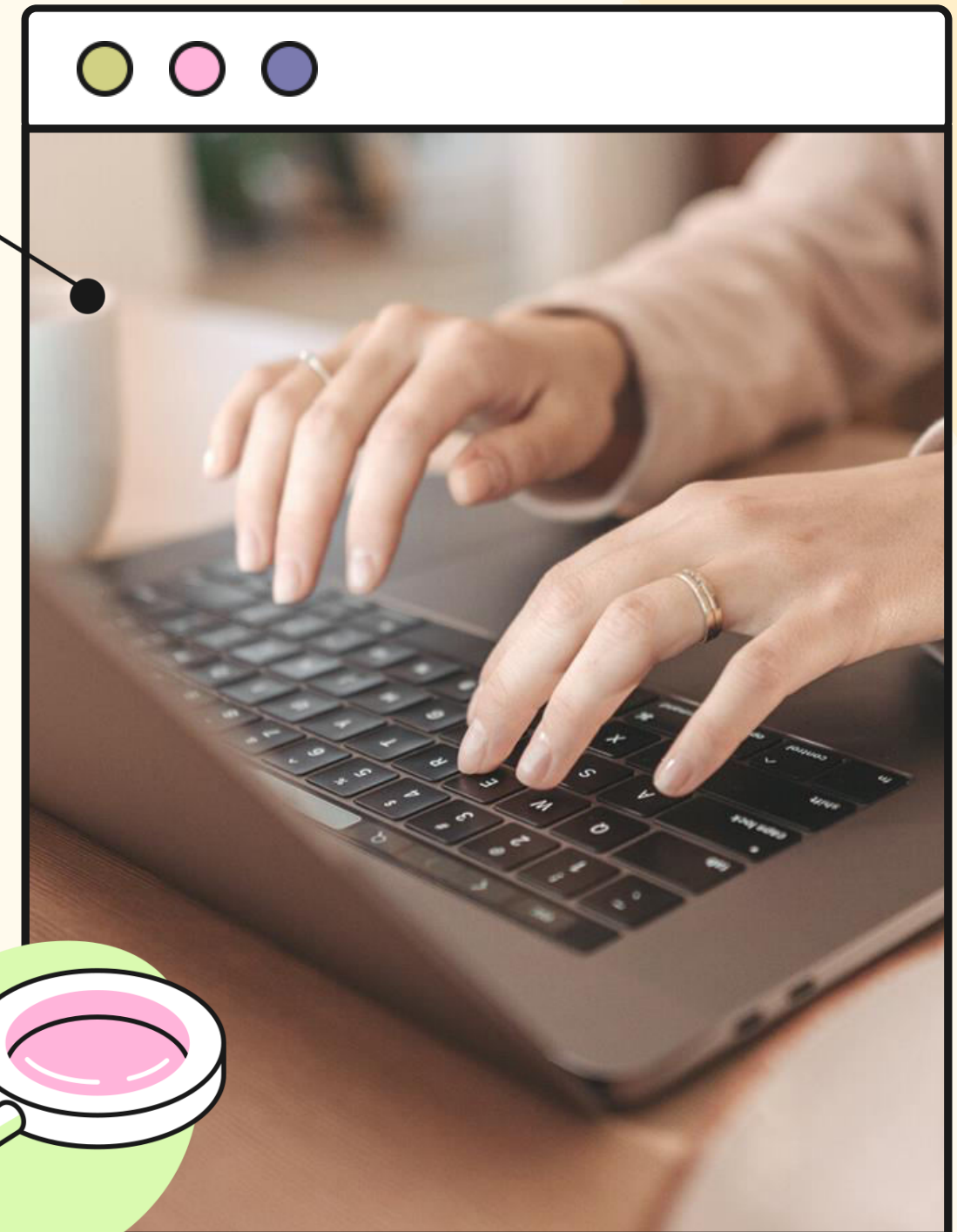


4.1

ANSWERING REQUESTS FOR INFORMATION AND ACTION

When you're answering requests and a potential sale is involved, you have three main goals:

- (1) to respond to the inquiry and answer all questions,
- (2) to leave your reader with a good impression of you and your firm, and (3)
- to encourage the future sale.





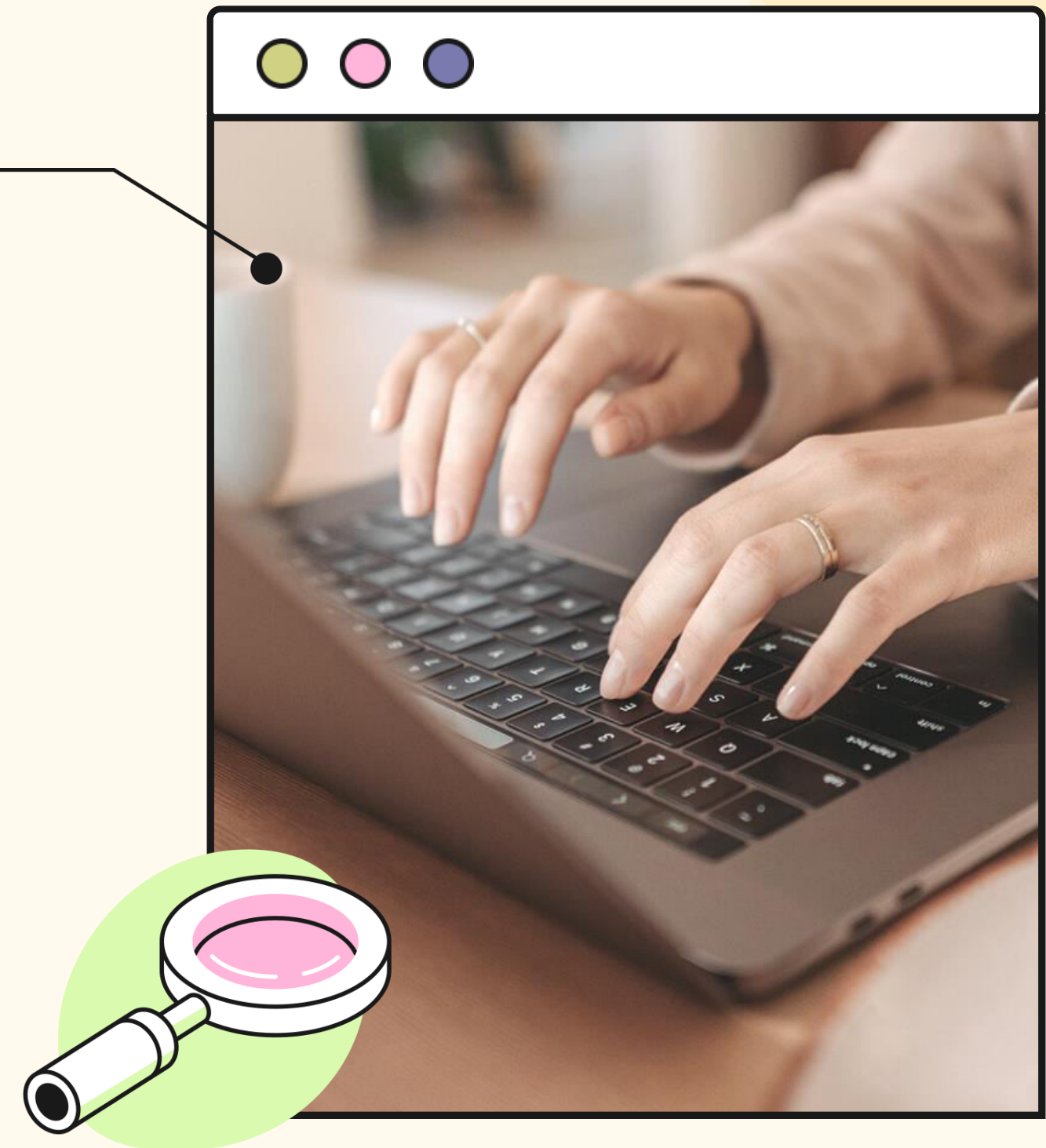
GRANTING CLAIMS AND REQUESTS FOR ADJUSTMENT

Responding to mistakes in a courteous, reader-focused way helps repair important business relationships.

Decide according to your company's policies for resolving such issues.

In general, take the following steps:

- Acknowledge receipt of the customer's claim or complaint.
- Sympathize with the customer's inconvenience or frustration.
- Take (or assign) personal responsibility for setting matters straight.
- Explain precisely how you have resolved, or plan to resolve, the situation.
- Take steps to repair the relationship.
- Follow up to verify that your response was correct.

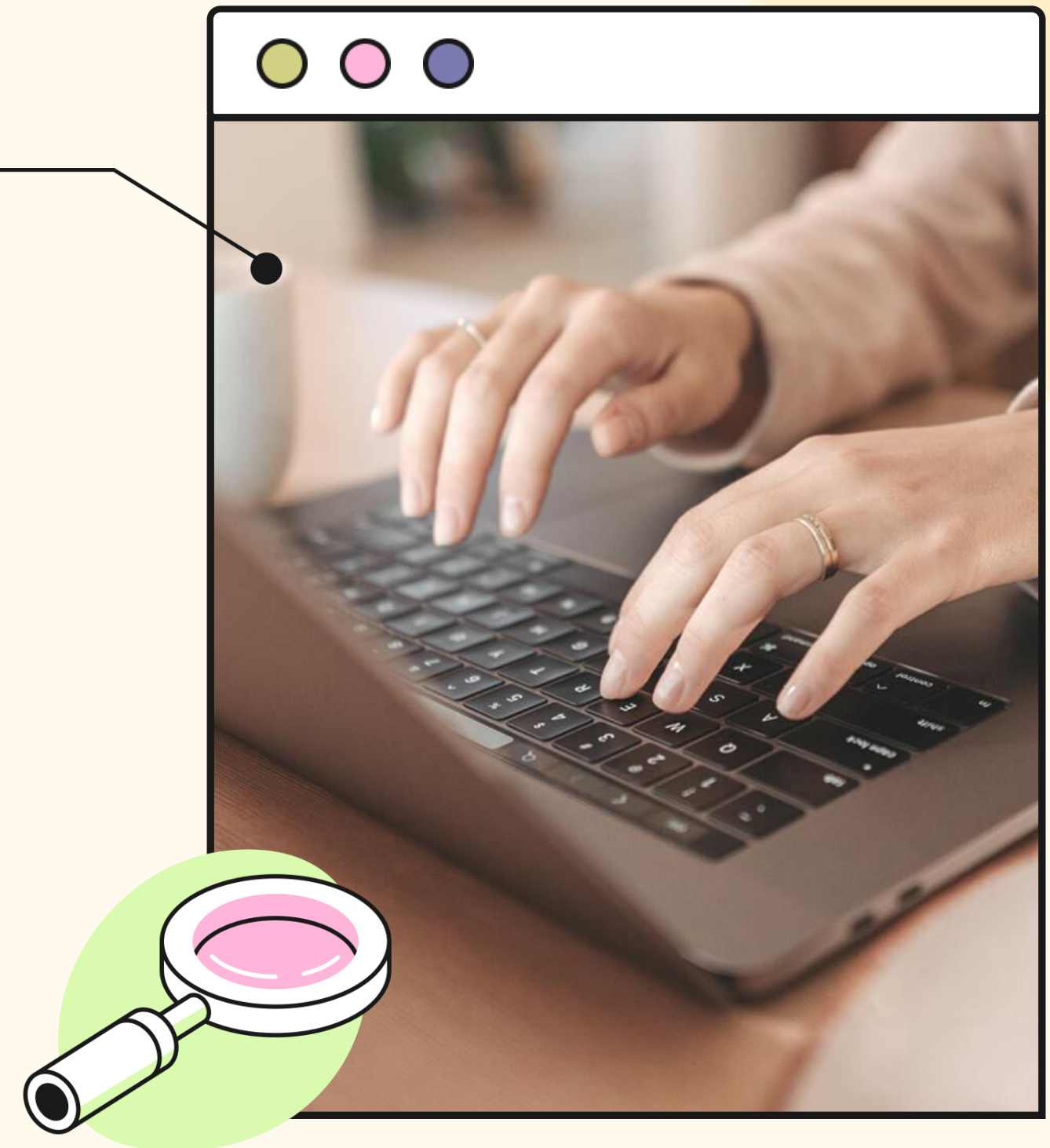




PROVIDING RECOMMENDATIONS AND REFERENCES

A successful recommendation letter contains a number of relevant details;

- The candidate's full name
- The position or other objective the candidate is seeking
- The nature of your relationship with the candidate
- Facts and evidence relevant to the candidate and the opportunity
- A comparison of this candidate's potential with that of peers, if available (for example, "Ms. Jonasson consistently ranked in the top 10 percent of our national sales force.")
- Your overall evaluation of the candidate's suitability for the opportunity



Point1 Promotions

105 E. Madison
Ann Arbor, MI 48103
tel: 800-747-9786
email: info@point1promo.net
www.point1promo.net

November 14, 2018

Ms. Clarice Gailey
Director of Operations
McNally and Associates, Inc.
8688 Southgate Ave.
Augusta, GA 30906

Dear Ms. Gailey:

I am pleased to recommend Talvin Biswas for the marketing position at McNally and Associates. Mr. Biswas has worked with Point1 Promotions as an intern for the past two summers while working toward his degree in marketing and advertising. His duties included customer correspondence, web content updates, and direct-mail campaign planning.

As his supervisor, in addition to knowing his work here, I also know that Mr. Biswas has served as secretary for the International Business Association at the University of Michigan. He tutored other international students in the university's writing center. His fluency in three languages (English, French, and Hindi) and thorough knowledge of other cultures will make him an immediate contributor to your international operations.

Mr. Biswas is a thoughtful and careful professional who will not hesitate to contribute ideas when invited to do so. In addition, because Mr. Biswas learns quickly, he will learn your company's routine with ease.

Mr. Biswas will make an excellent addition to your staff at McNally and Associates. If I can provide any additional information, please call me at the number above. If you prefer to communicate by email, my address is angela_leclerc@point1promo.net.

Sincerely,

Angela LeClerc

Angela LeClerc
Vice President, Marketing

LeClerc specifies the duration and nature of the relationship in the body to give credibility to her evaluation. →

← The opening clearly states the candidate's full name and the specific purpose of the letter.

← The body continues with specific examples to support the writer's positive evaluation.

← The close summarizes the writer's recommendation and invites further communication.



4.4

SHARING ROUTINE INFORMATION

When sharing routine information

- State the purpose at the beginning and briefly mention the nature of the information you are providing
- Provide the necessary details
- End with a courteous close





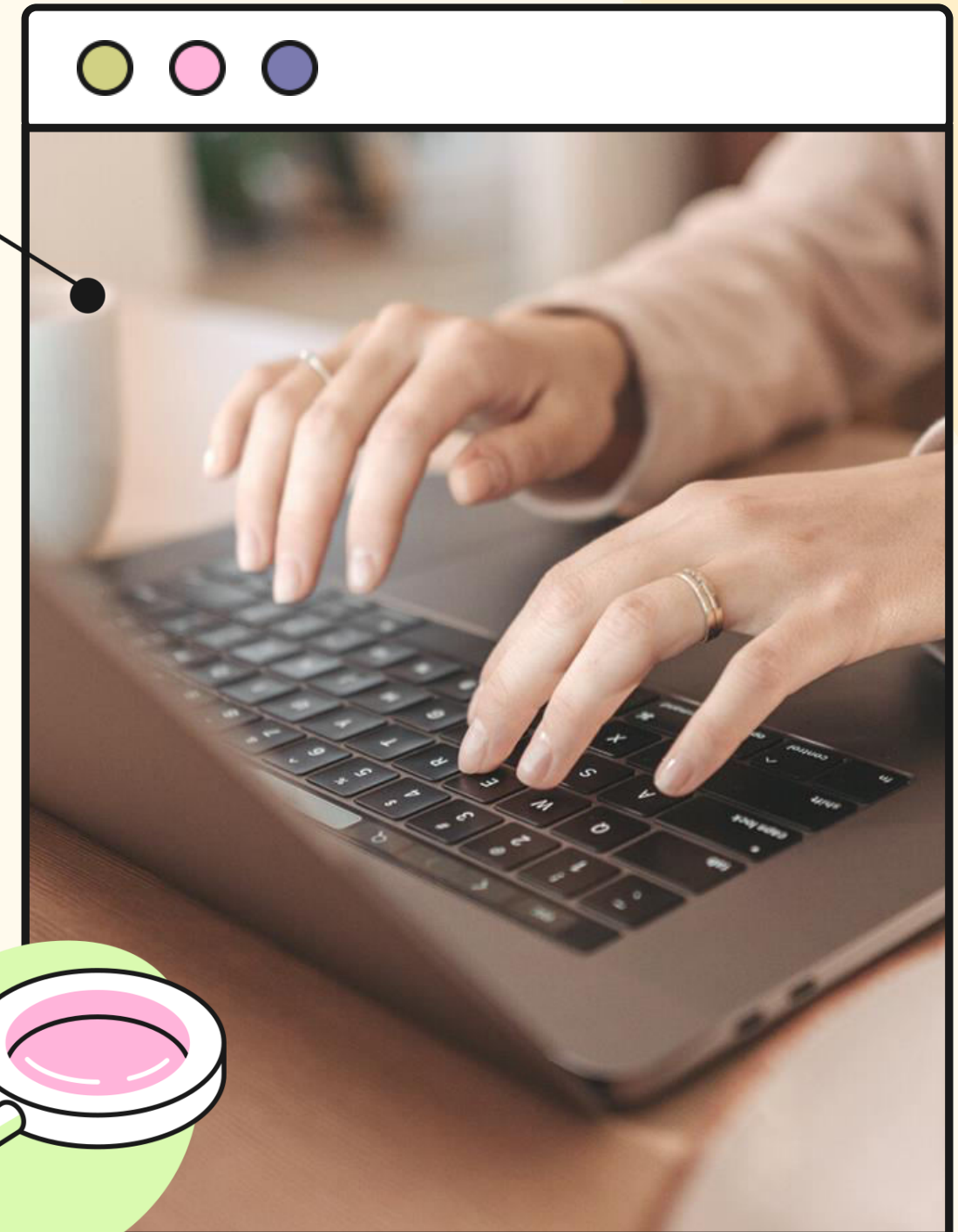
4.5

ANNOUNCING GOOD NEWS

External good-news announcements are often communicated in a news release

The content follows the customary pattern for a positive message: good news followed by details and a positive close.

direct-to-consumer news releases/ social media releases
includes ready-to-share content that is easy to reuse in
blog posts, tweets and other social media formats.



BANK OF THE YEAR - PAKISTAN

"THE BANKER" - THE MOST PRESTIGIOUS BANKING PUBLICATION IN THE WORLD

We are honoured to announce that Allied Bank has won the prestigious **"Bank of the Year 2021 – PAKISTAN"** award, by **The Banker***. This award is an affirmation of Allied Bank's sustained strategic resilience, customer focused integrated solutions and uninterrupted digital banking services.

Allied Bank offers world class convenience through a range of **Digital Banking Products**, nationwide network of **1,409 online branches** and **1,564 ATMs**.



*The Banker is a monthly international financial affairs publication of Financial Times group of London U.K since 1926 for last 95 years.



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4.6

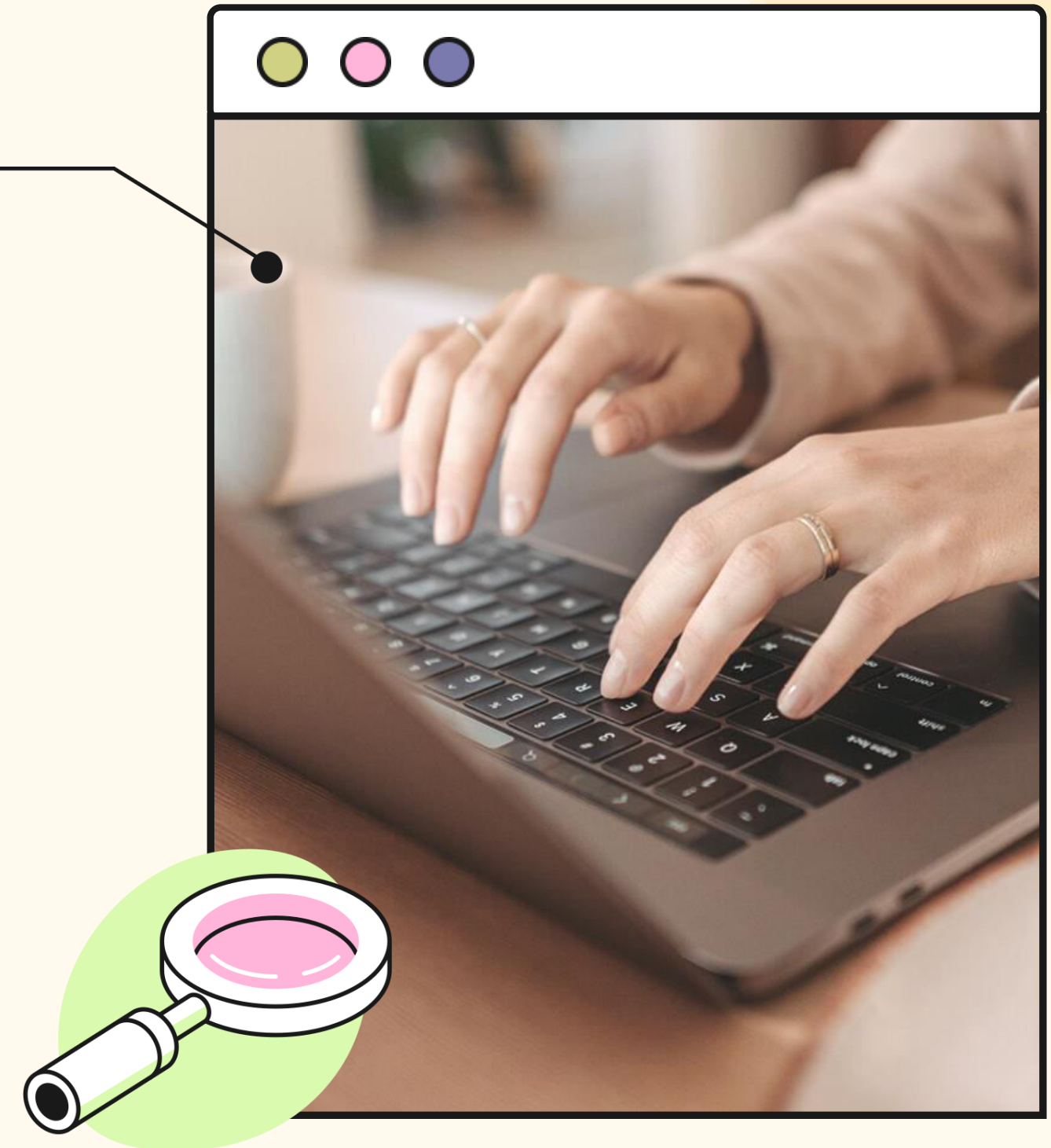
FOSTERING GOODWILL

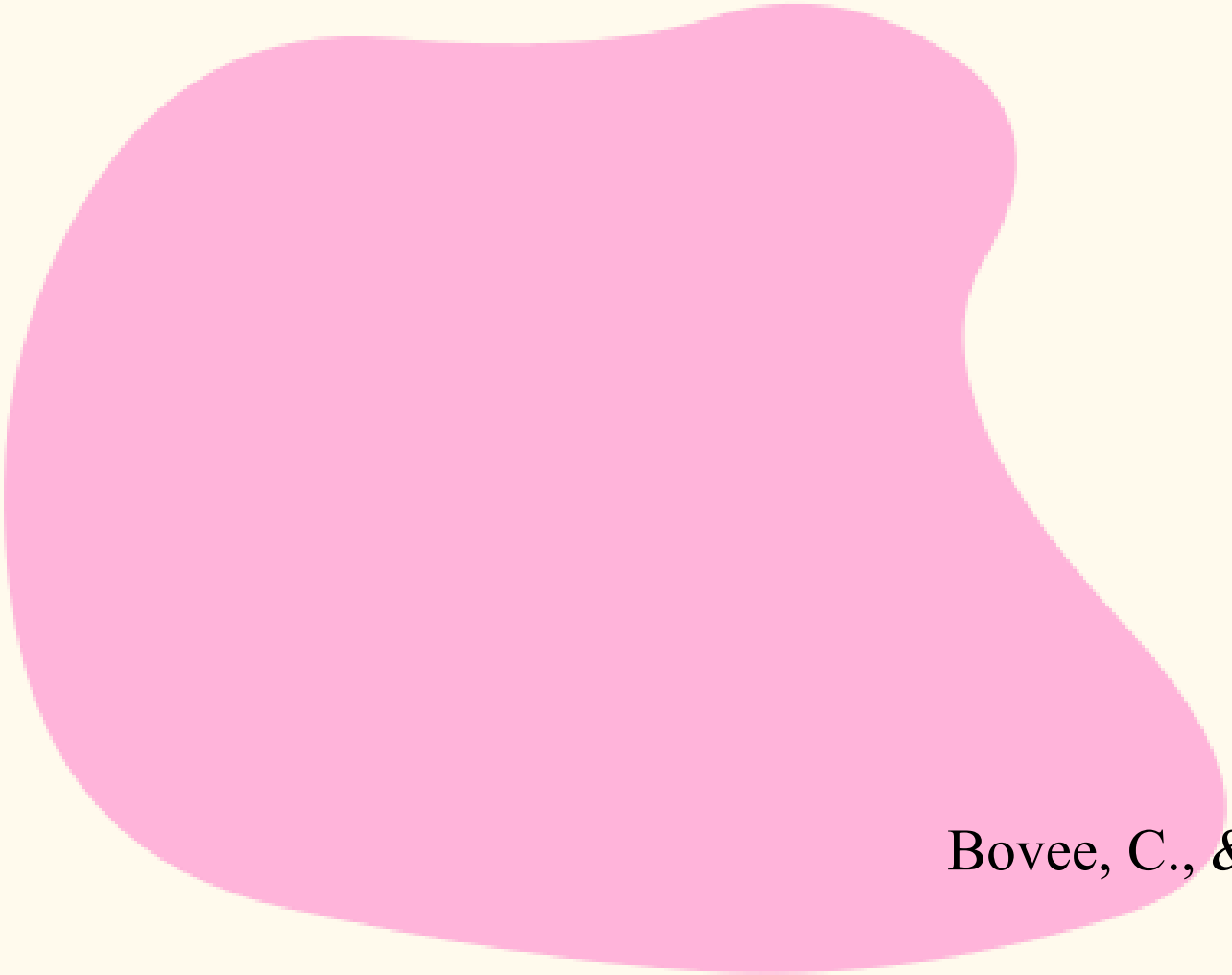
Goodwill is the positive feeling that encourages people to maintain a business relationship.

Sending congratulations

Sending message for appreciation

Offering condolence





Thank you!

Bovee, C., & Thill, J. (2017, January 4). *Business Communication Today* (14th ed.). Pearson.